Avatars Realm Website Review and Update Brief

Prepared for the developer. Reviewed against the client's Revised Change Summary. Live site: https://avatars-realm.vercel.app/ (review date: 16 October 2026).

Hi,

I have reviewed the live site page by page against the client's revised change summary. The inner pages are mostly in line with it, but there are content errors that must be fixed and several design improvements I'd like you to make. Please work through the list in order of priority.

A. Critical content fixes (must be done first)

1. Home page still shows the old version

- The nav is old (Esports Academy / Pricing / Events). All other pages use the new nav (Academy Programmes / Memberships & Lounge / Arena & Events / Open Championship 2026). Please make the nav identical on every page.
- Old claims need to go: "established academy", "Open 7 Days", "Walk-ins Welcome", "Free Intake Session", "20 PC stations", "120-seat arena", "6 broadcast booths", "founder-director since 2023", "open daily and running a full coaching timetable".
- Old prices need to go: Starter R450, Competitor R850, Elite Squad R1,400, drop-in R45/hour. Current pilot pricing is lounge R40 / R50 / R70, packs R225 / R400, memberships R399 / R899 / R1,999, Institution R12,500 per term.
- "Entries are open now" and "21–22 November 2026" must be removed. The Championship page says dates and registration are to be announced. The "qualifying ladders running on the floor" line also contradicts the pre-launch status.
- Meta title, meta description and OG tags still say "established esports academy … junior programmes, team bootcamps". Update them to the new positioning: "Train. Play. Compete. Belong."
- Home links to /esports-academy/ and /events/. Make sure these either redirect to /academy-programmes/ and /arena-events/ or are removed. Also check that no 404s remain.

- The "Join Now" button goes to /pricing/. Enrolment is not open, so change it to "Register Interest" (link to Contact).
- "Book a free session" has no booking system behind it and the free session is not in the brief. Change it to "Email the team".
- The page should be shorter. Structure it as: Hero → Academy / Lounge / Arena summary (3 cards) → Academy pathway teaser (monthly fees) → Championship teaser → Contact CTA. Details live on the inner pages.

2. Academy Programmes page still has the old pricing

- Currently: Beginner 4 weeks R3,500, Intermediate 8 weeks R7,500, Pro 6 months R15,000. This appears in the hero strip and the cards.
- Replace with:
  - **Beginner Programme: R1,500 per month.** A three-month foundation pathway. The first four weeks establish fundamentals, then performance assessments guide your next step.
  - **Intermediate Programme: R2,200 per month.** A six-month development pathway for players ready to turn practice into reliable match performance and prepare for league competition.
  - **Pro Programme: R1,800 per month.** A twelve-month performance pathway for committed players seeking disciplined training, advanced review and sustained competition preparation.
- Show the monthly fee as the biggest element on each card. Show the duration ("3 months", "6 months", "12 months") as a secondary label. Do not show full programme totals as the main message.
- Keep "Proposed pilot pricing" on every card.
- Pro is cheaper per month than Intermediate. Add a short line on the Pro card ("in exchange for a 12-month commitment") so this doesn't look like a mistake.
- The FAQ on the Memberships page already uses the new model, so the Academy page must match it.

3. Pre-launch wording must be consistent

- The Arena page says some zones are "open to walk-ins today". Everywhere else says the opening programme is still to be announced. Remove "today" and describe zones as planned or opening with the launch programme.
- About says "developing", Home says "established". Use the same status everywhere.

4. League frequency

- Currently: "Monthly or seasonal" (Arena), "Seasonal or monthly" (Events card), "Monthly league windows" (FAQ), "Runs weekly" (community sessions). Use one consistent description. The final choice (weekly, monthly or seasonal) is being confirmed with the client; use a single placeholder until then.

5. Quarterly tournament calendar (Q1–Q4)

- It is October 2026, so Q1–Q3 have passed. Update the calendar (for example show it as the "2026 / 2027 tournament programme" with dates "to be confirmed") rather than listing past windows as upcoming.
- Replace "Title rotation confirmed" with "Planned, subject to confirmation".
- Clarify how Q4 "Year-end championship finals" relates to the Open Esports Championship 2026. At the moment it is unclear whether they are the same event.

6. Planned items must stay labelled

- Two-day format, open / member divisions, the R90,000 prize pool, and Realm Points earning and redemption rules: all labelled "Planned / Proposed / Subject to confirmation" wherever they appear.

B. Page-by-page notes

Home

See A1. Also remove the double marquee strip (see section C).

About

- The "Ho" initials for Head of Coaching look like a placeholder. Replace with a neutral "To be announced" avatar or icon.
- The Start / Develop / Compete / Belong journey is repeated on About and Academy. Keep the full version on About only and a one-line link on Academy.

Academy Programmes

See A2. In "Schools & Groups", link to the Institution card on Memberships (verify the anchor works).

Memberships & Lounge (/pricing/ redirects here, which is fine)

- "Food & beverage" appears twice in "The Lounge Experience" (items 02 and 06 are near duplicates). Merge them.
- Social Pass and Pro Pathway cards repeat the hours twice (as sub-heading and again as a bullet). Show once.
- The Institution card shows "per term" twice.
- Use one currency format: "R1,999" everywhere (the home page uses "R1 400").
- The FAQ answers are good. Keep them.

Arena & Events

- The Championship description appears here in full and again on the Championship page. Keep a short teaser here (title, five titles, link).
- The Q1–Q4 list appears here and on the Championship page. Keep the full list on Arena & Events only.

Open Esports Championship 2026

- The "Tournament Atmosphere" section uses photos of real third-party venues (KeyArena Seattle, SSE Arena Wembley, Copper Box). Confirm the licences or replace them with licensed stock or client-owned photos. The same images are on the home page.
- The "Wider Rhythm" Q1–Q4 block duplicates Arena & Events. Remove it or reduce it to a single link.

Contact

- Good overall. Keep the "no form" approach (per brief).
- Hours are "indicative". Make sure nothing elsewhere says "Open 7 days" as a fact.

Global / footer

- A "Loading" text appears at the end of every page. Make sure the preloader is removed or hidden once the page has loaded.
- The status chips ("Enrolment opening soon", "Proposed pilot pricing", "Championship 2026") repeat on every page together with the sentence "Opening programme and membership enrolment to be announced" in the hero, the CTA and the footer. Show the status sentence once per page (hero) and keep only a small one-line note in the footer.

- The OG title and og:url are the same on every page (and point to the home page). Give each page its own og:title, og:description and og:url.
- The header button "View Programmes" is the same on every page. On the Academy page itself it should change to "Register Interest".

C. Home page hero redesign

The current hero needs to be redesigned as follows:

- **Headline:** "Train. Play. Compete. Belong." (replace "Serious esports. Still being built.", which sounds unfinished).
- **Sub-line:** "An esports academy, gaming lounge and arena in Northcliff, Randburg."
- **Status badge:** one small badge: "Opening programme to be announced". Remove the two separate "In development" / "Planned" tags.
- **Buttons:** one primary ("Explore Programmes") and one secondary / outline ("Open Championship 2026"). Same height, and full width on mobile.
- **Visual:** the hero currently loads 13 images. Use one strong full-bleed image (the dark player-focus image) with a dark gradient overlay (left to right) so text is readable, or a small 3-image collage. Load the rest lazily or remove them.
- **Under the hero:** replace the scrolling marquee ("Open 7 Days ◆ Walk-ins Welcome ◆ Free Intake Session...") with a 4-step strip: **Train → Play → Compete → Belong**, each with an icon and a one-line description. The old marquee contradicts the pre-launch status.
- **Mobile:** headline max 2–3 lines, buttons stacked and full width, image never behind the text without an overlay.
- Add a subtle entrance animation only (fade / slide up). Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`.

D. Design improvements (all pages)

Layout and alignment

- Use one container width (max about 1200px) and the same side padding on every page. Check that headings, body text and cards share the same left edge.
- Use a consistent vertical rhythm between sections (for example 96px desktop / 56px mobile). Some sections look very tight against others.

- Cards in the same row should have equal heights. Align prices and buttons to the bottom of the card.
- Keep headings left-aligned throughout (or centred throughout), not mixed.

Pricing and programme cards

- Price large (monthly fee), duration small beneath, "pilot pricing" as a small tag.
- Highlight "Most popular" with a coloured border and badge, not just a label.
- Use a simple 3-step progress visual for Beginner → Intermediate → Pro (3 / 6 / 12 months) so visitors see the journey at a glance.

Status labels

- Make status tags look consistent: "Proposed" (amber), "Planned" (blue), "Coming soon" (purple). One tag style, used the same way on every page.

Arena zones

- Present the seven zones as a clean grid (3 columns on desktop, 1 on mobile), with the same image ratio (for example 4:3) and a small "Open at launch" or "Future" tag on each.

Tournament calendar

- Present as a horizontal timeline on desktop and a vertical list on mobile, with the date as "TBC" until confirmed.

Typography and colour

- Limit to two fonts (one display, one body). Check heading sizes follow a fixed scale, and body text is at least 16px with line-height about 1.6.
- Use one accent colour for buttons and highlights. Check text contrast against the dark background (WCAG AA).

Images and performance

- Convert large JPG / PNG files to WebP, set proper `sizes`, and lazy-load everything below the fold. The hero should be the only priority image.
- All content images need meaningful alt text. Decorative ones should have empty alt.

Navigation and CTA

- Make the header sticky with a clear active-page state. On mobile, use a simple menu that closes after tapping a link.
- Every page should end with one clear CTA ("Email the team"). Avoid several different CTAs competing in the same section.
- Add visible keyboard focus styles on links and buttons.

E. Please confirm when done

1. Home page deployed (not a cache issue) and old prices / claims gone.
2. Academy page shows R1,500 / R2,200 / R1,800 per month with durations.
3. No 404s from /esports-academy/ and /events/.
4. Tournament calendar updated, league frequency consistent.
5. Hero redesigned, mobile checked at 375px and 768px.
6. Image licences confirmed.

Please send me the updated link once these are done. Thank you.